Scopus AI

Click to schedule a meeting with the DITI Team

Summary

Scopus AI is a literature search and summarization tool that uses a customized large language model, a form of artificial intelligence (AI), to develop search queries and generate textual and visual summaries of literature. Northeastern University has a subscription to Scopus AI. If you are associated with Northeastern, you can log in using your university email and credentials.

This handout provides a guide to Scopus AI's primary capabilities. The impacts of generative AI and the range of its capabilities are rapidly changing, so please be aware that any information provided here should be taken in tandem with your current knowledge of these subjects. Please also note that you should follow your professor's stated guidelines for AI use in your class. For more information on Northeastern University AI policies as well as AI tutorials and tips, visit the Northeastern Center for Advancing Teaching and Learning Through Research.

AI Ethics

AI ethics are a large and complex topic. Before you use an AI tool, consider how it derives information, what/whom its sources are, what information it is privileging or leaving out, which resources are depleted by its use, and which communities are harmed in its development and use. For more information on AI ethics and bias as they pertain to literature reviews, please see our AI for Literature Reviews slides.

Strengths and Weaknesses

Scopus AI can be a useful tool for broadening your understanding of themes in literature on a topic spanning multiple fields. However, it is still necessary for researchers to critically evaluate the search results to identify which are relevant and to follow up with targeted searches, including in other databases.

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Strengths

- Queries can be entered in languages other than English
- Can identify a wider range of relevant sources from other disciplines than a traditional keyword search
- Draws from a variety of peer-reviewed sources including books, articles, conference papers, and reports
- AI assisted search displays the steps taken in gathering and summarizing literature and queries are not used in training data

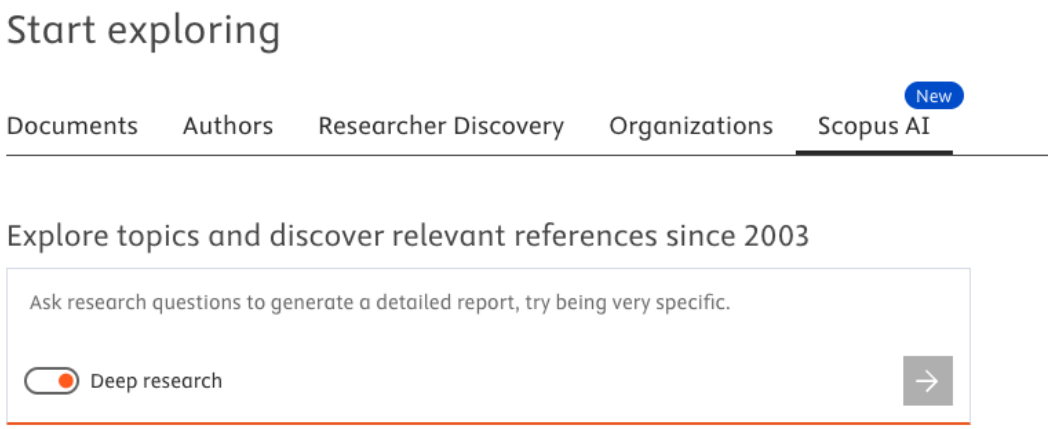
Weaknesses

- Quality of results is impacted by search specificity and results cannot be reproduced
- Researchers may be overwhelmed by the breadth of results
- Results may be biased toward Elsevier journals

Using Scopus AI

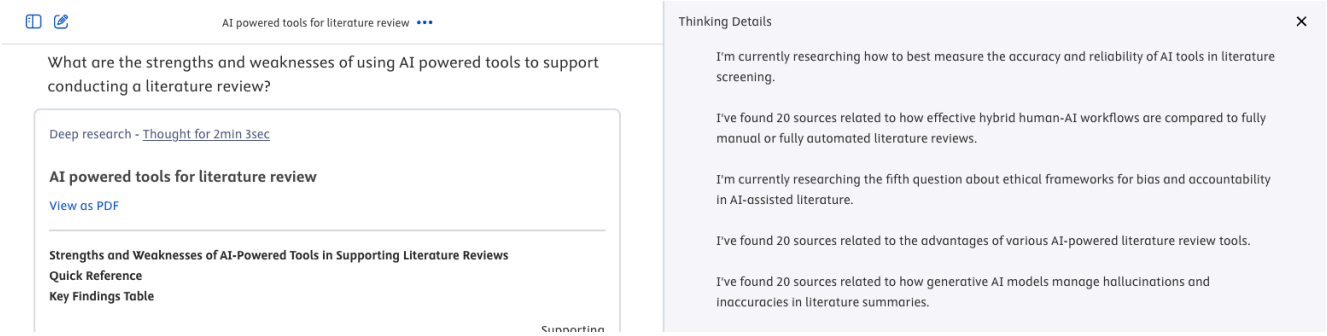
When using Scopus AI, it is important to carefully evaluate the results and the steps that the AI model took to generate the results, as well as to follow up with additional searches.

1. Go to https://www-scopus-com.ezproxy.neu.edu/pages/home#basic and log in using your Northeastern credentials.
2. Select **Scopus AI** under **Start exploring**.
3. Enter your research question (you may need to sign in again to save your search). Specific research questions focused on summarizing existing literature (such as "What are the strengths and weaknesses of using AI powered tools to support conducting a literature review?") may generate more relevant results than general questions (such as "Is AI useful for research?"). You can also include contextual information, such as "Focus on studies published after 2023," to increase the relevance of results. If you prefer, you can enable **Deep research**, which is a setting that generates a report including research gaps and recommended next steps. Note that if you enable **Deep research**, the options to create a **Concept Map** and view **Topic Experts** and **Emerging Themes** may not be available until you ask a follow up question.



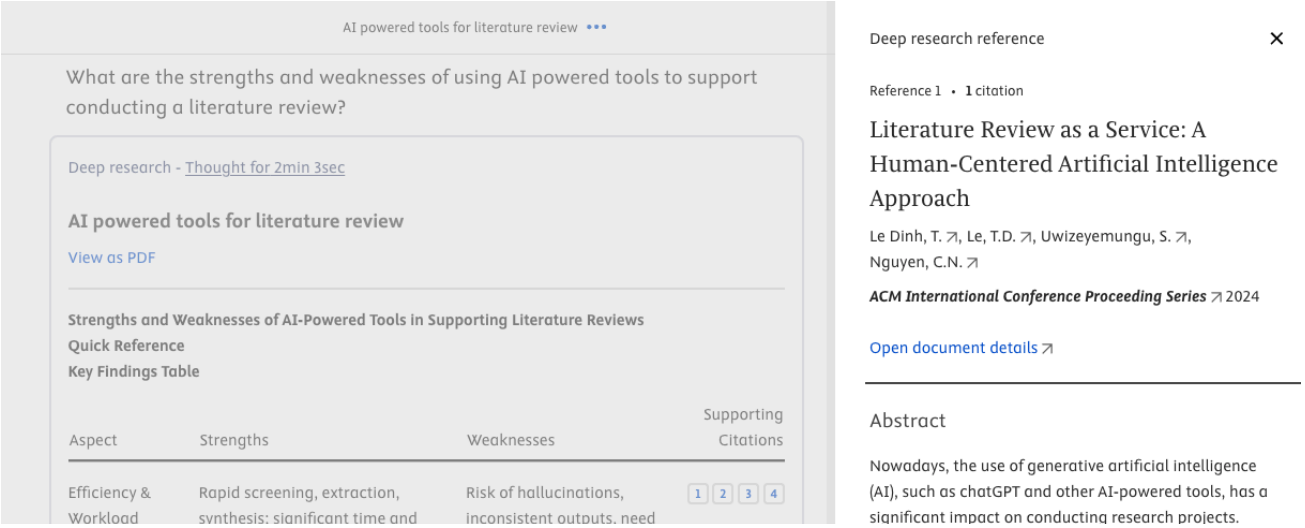
Caption: Scopus AI landing page, including text box for research question.

4. Review research steps by clicking **Thought for**... in the upper left corner. These steps can provide insight into potential keywords to be used in subsequent searches.



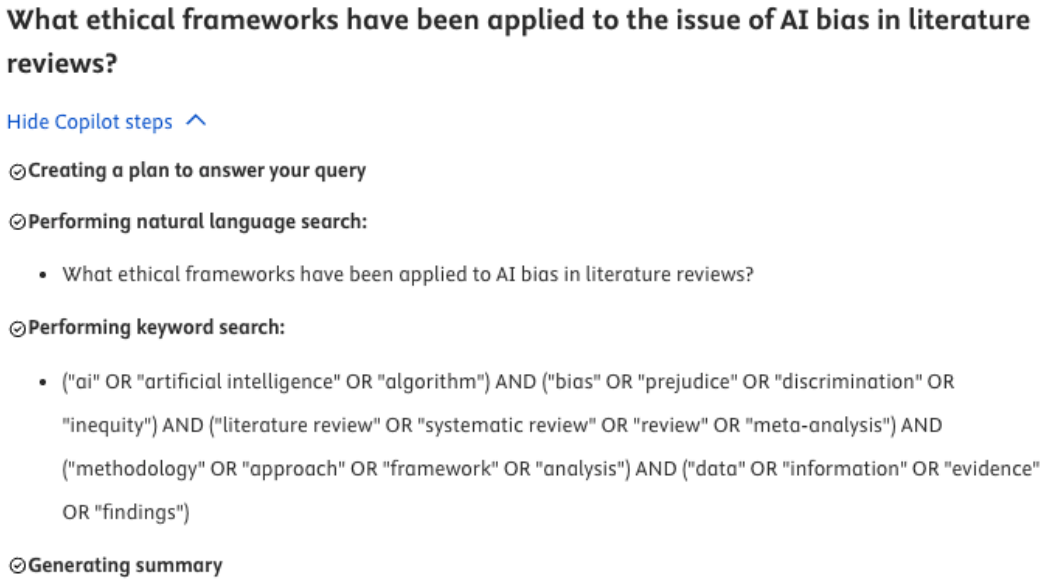
Caption: **Thinking Details** showing the steps by which the AI retrieved the results.

5. Review results. To show the reference supporting each result, click on the reference number displayed under **Supporting Citations**.



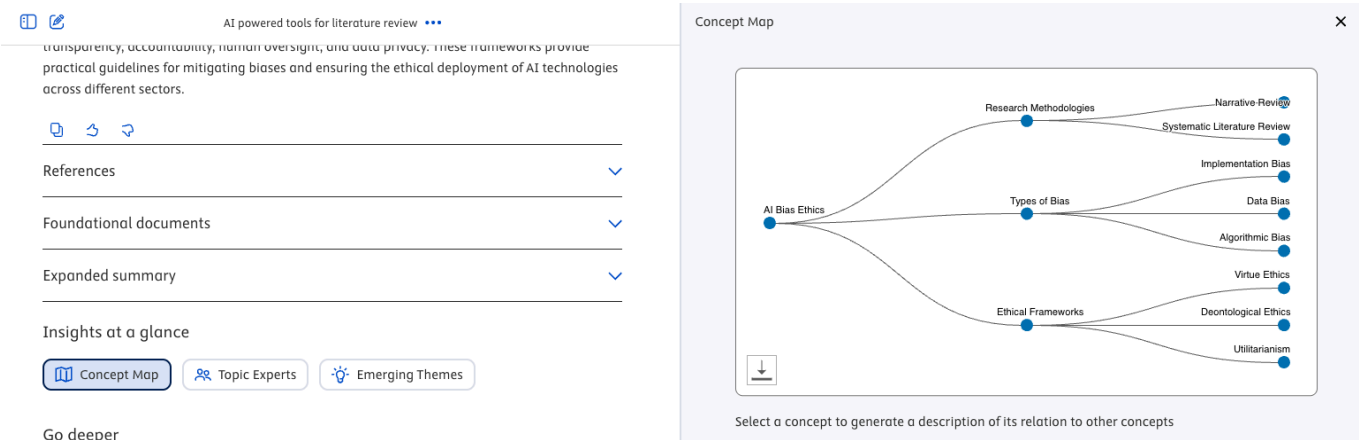
Caption: Reference information for supporting citation.

6. To view all references, scroll to the end of the response and click **Show all references**.
7. Click **View as PDF** and save results.
8. After you have performed an initial search, you can ask follow up questions and select **Show Copilot steps** to review how the follow up search was performed. Reviewing the Copilot steps can help you identify keywords to use in further searches.



Caption: Copilot steps used to answer the question, “What ethical frameworks have been applied to the issue of AI bias in literature reviews?”

9. Review the **Concept Map**, **Topic Experts**, and **Emerging Themes** to identify potential directions for continuing your literature review.



Caption: Concept map generated from literature results.

10. After you have performed an initial search with Scopus AI, we recommend performing additional searches in other databases.

Further Resources

- AI at Northeastern University, Northeastern Information Technology Services
- Education literature review search strategies: AI and Library resources, Lindley Homol, Northeastern
- Communication Studies : AI tools for your research, Northeastern University Library
- Collaborating on Literature Reviews with AI, Daniel Serig, Northeastern Center for Advancing Teaching and Learning Through Research
- Data Ethics: Understanding Big Data and Algorithmic Bias, Digital Integration Teaching Initiative
- AI for Literature Reviews, Digital Integration Teaching Initiative
- Scopus LibGuide: Scopus AI, Elsevier
- Scopus AI Quick Reference Guide, Elsevier

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